

# Shungite Market Research & Commercial Analysis 2024

## Executive Summary

Shungite is a carbon-rich mineraloid from Russia's Karelia region, marketed for water purification, EMF protection, and wellness applications. Contains 30-98% carbon in three varieties: regular (30-50%), elite (98%+), and Petrovsky. Global market operates through online retailers and wellness stores, with products ranging \$3-200+. Scientific evidence supporting health claims remains limited, facing regulatory scrutiny. Primary consumers include wellness enthusiasts and alternative health practitioners.

## Quick Answers

**What:** Raw stones, shaped products (pyramids, spheres), jewelry, water filtration items, décor **Good for:** Water purification (some evidence), claimed EMF protection (unproven), wellness practices, decoration **Why needed:** Growing alternative wellness demand, EMF concerns, natural filtration interest, collector market

## Deep Dive

**Overview:** 2-billion-year-old mineraloid found exclusively in Russian Karelia. Carbon content 5-98%, black/gray color, electrical conductivity present.

**Types:** Regular (30-50% carbon, \$3-50), Elite (98%+ carbon, premium pricing), Petrovsky (5-10% carbon, lower grade)

**Market:** Online/specialty retail distribution. Wholesale \$2-200/kg depending on grade. Major suppliers: Karelian Heritage, Shungite Life, various distributors.

**Setup:** Water use: 100-150g per liter, 24-48hr contact time. EMF placement: near devices, worn as jewelry.

## Pros & Cons

| Pros                                        | Cons                                          |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Some documented water filtration properties | Limited scientific evidence for health claims |
| Affordable pricing, wide product variety    | Regulatory concerns, quality inconsistency    |
| Established supply chains                   | Single source region, shipping costs          |

## Competitors

**Minerals:** Black Tourmaline (EMF protection claims, \$5-50+), Himalayan Salt (air purification, \$15-100+), Zeolite (detox claims, \$20-80+) **Proven Alternatives:** Activated Carbon (water filtration, \$10-100+), EMF Shields by DefenderShield (FCC tested, \$50-300+), HEPA filters (air purification, \$100-500+)

## Comparison Matrix

Table 1 – Basics

| Product          | Company           | Form Factor             | Best For                    | Links                |
|------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|
| Shungite         | Karelian Heritage | Stones/Jewelry/Pyramids | Water treatment, collectors | karelianheritage.com |
| Black Tourmaline | Various suppliers | Raw/polished stones     | Metaphysical practices      | gemstone retailers   |
| Activated Carbon | 3M, Culligan      | Filters/cartridges      | Proven water filtration     | culligan.com         |
| EMF Shields      | DefenderShield    | Fabric cases/clothing   | Verified EMF reduction      | defendershield.com   |

Table 2 – Capabilities

| Product          | Application Method                | Effectiveness Claims             | Scientific Validation        | Processing Type       |
|------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Shungite         | Water contact/proximity placement | Water purification, EMF blocking | Partial (water only)         | Natural mineral       |
| Black Tourmaline | Proximity placement/wearing       | Grounding, EMF protection        | None                         | Natural mineral       |
| Activated Carbon | Direct filtration                 | Contaminant adsorption           | Extensive laboratory testing | Engineered processing |
| EMF Shields      | Physical barrier/enclosure        | RF/EMF attenuation               | FCC testing, lab verified    | Engineered materials  |

Table 3 – Ecosystem

| Product          | Distribution Channels           | Quality Standards       | Regulatory Status        |
|------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| Shungite         | Online/wellness stores          | No standardization      | Consumer protection laws |
| Black Tourmaline | Gem shops/metaphysical stores   | Mineral grading systems | Minimal regulation       |
| Activated Carbon | Hardware/water treatment        | NSF/ANSI standards      | EPA regulated            |
| EMF Shields      | Direct sales/electronics stores | FCC compliance          | FCC regulated devices    |

Table 4 – Commercials

| Product          | Pricing Range | Trial Options            | Key Limitations                       |
|------------------|---------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Shungite         | \$3-200+      | 30-day returns (typical) | Single source region, unproven claims |
| Black Tourmaline | \$5-50+       | Return policies vary     | No proven EMF effects                 |
| Activated Carbon | \$10-100+     | Performance guarantees   | Requires regular replacement          |
| EMF Shields      | \$50-300+     | 90-day guarantees        | Device-specific, limited coverage     |

Decision Guide

**Wellness Enthusiast:** Regular shungite \$10-30, focus on water use **Water Quality:** Supplement proven filtration systems **EMF Protection:** Consider FCC-tested alternatives over shungite **Collector:** Elite shungite for rarity, verify Russian sourcing

**Red Flags:** Medical claims, suspiciously cheap products, unverified suppliers

Implementation

**Setup:** Water: rinse stones, 100-150g/liter, 24hr contact. Clean monthly. **Sourcing:** Verify Karelia origin certificates, start with small orders **Maintenance:** Regular cleaning, monitor for damage, track suppliers

Sources

- 1. [Healthline - Shungite Properties](#)
- 2. [Karelian Heritage - Products](#)
- 3. [Wikipedia - Shungite Overview](#)
- 4. [Geology Science - Formation](#)
- 5. [MinDat - Mineralogy](#)